



Come for the books, stay for the wine

ASSISTANT MANAGER, HOSPITALITY

Job Description

About The Role

There's nothing better than a good book with a good glass of wine. At the BookCellar, we're building a space where that simple pleasure is at the heart of everything we do. This is an independent bookshop in Stokes Croft, Bristol, with an integrated reading room serving wine, coffee, and light food throughout the day and evening. We have approximately twenty-five covers on the shop floor and meeting rooms for up to twenty-four people — multiple spaces for customers to linger, discover, and enjoy.

As Assistant Manager for Hospitality, you are responsible for making The BookCellar a place people want to stay. The reading room is at the heart of our offer — not an afterthought, not a café bolted on to a bookshop, but a genuinely hospitable space where the right atmosphere, the right drink, and the right book come together. You'll take ownership of that experience: the wine and food offer, the feel of the room, the quality of service, and the sense that every customer who walks in is welcome to settle in and spend time with us. You are first and foremost a member of our bookselling team, but your particular focus is on the hospitality that makes The BookCellar somewhere people return to.

Our food and drink offer is deliberately simple and premium — three reds, three whites, a rosé, and a sparkling by the glass, a small by-the-bottle retail selection, a monthly wine pairing, single origin filter coffee, and a concise food offer of cheese, pastries, cakes, and charcuterie. Everything is prepared and served front of house by our booksellers. There is no back of house, no kitchen, no separate hospitality team. That simplicity is a core part of what makes us different, and you'll be responsible for making it work beautifully.

Key Responsibilities

Bookselling

- Work on the shop floor, welcoming customers and creating a warm, engaging atmosphere
- Help customers find the right books through conversation and recommendation
- Contribute to stock management, including receiving, shelving, and stock-taking
- Support the book and wine pairing concept across the whole team

Reading Room and Atmosphere

- Take ownership of the reading room experience — atmosphere, presentation, pace, and feel

- Ensure the space is always welcoming, well-presented, and somewhere customers want to linger
- Create the conditions for customers to settle in, spend time, and come back
- Work with the team to maintain consistent standards of service and hospitality throughout the day and evening

Food and Drink Operations

- Curate and manage our wine, coffee, and food selection — three reds, three whites, a rosé, and a sparkling by the glass, plus a small by-the-bottle retail selection and a monthly wine pairing
- Build and maintain relationships with wine merchants, coffee roasters, and food suppliers
- Manage stock ordering, rotation, and storage to maintain quality and minimise waste
- Ensure the food and drink offer remains simple, elegant, and executable by all booksellers without specialist equipment or back-of-house support

Compliance

- Take day-to-day responsibility for food hygiene and safety procedures
- Ensure compliance with licensing requirements and our premises licence obligations
- Train and support the team on food safety, alcohol service, and licensing requirements
- Maintain required records and documentation
- Support food and drink service for events in our meeting rooms
- Serve as a key holder and duty manager at times, with responsibility for opening, closing, and licensing compliance during shifts

What We're Looking For

- Genuine passion for books and knowledge across both fiction and non-fiction genres
- Enthusiasm for hand-selling and recommending titles
- Proven experience in hospitality — bar, restaurant, or similar environment
- A passion for wine, food, and the concept of pairing them with books
- The ability to keep things simple, elegant, and premium — resisting unnecessary complexity
- Strong supplier and relationship-building skills
- A methodical approach to compliance and food safety
- Confidence to train and guide colleagues on the food and drink offer
- Reliability and willingness to muck in across everything
- Personal Licence and Food Hygiene Certificate highly desirable — we'll train and certify if needed

Development and Growth

You'll be part of a team building something different. The BookCellar is our first outlet, but we're establishing a repeatable model that we plan to scale nationally. This role is specifically for someone with ambition beyond the shop floor — someone who sees hospitality and retail management as a career, and who wants to grow into a General Manager or operations leadership role as we expand to new locations.

We're a small, ambitious business at the start of something. That means the opportunities are real and the progression is genuine, with a direct path to senior responsibility as we scale. If you want to build something, learn how an independent retail and hospitality business works from the inside, and grow with us as we do, this is the right role.

As with all our team, you'll also have direct access to the publishing community, and we'll make sure you feel at home in the book world as well as the business.

Terms and Benefits

This is a salaried role at £28,000 pro-rata. We are looking for candidates available between 30 and 40 hours per week (including some evenings and weekends), and we will agree a schedule that works for both parties. As with all roles at the BookCellar, the expectation is that you are first and foremost a bookseller, with your managerial responsibilities picked up during quieter periods on the shop floor.

- Salary: £28,000 pro-rata
- Hours: 30–40 hours per week
- Holiday: 28 days per year pro-rata
- Pension: statutory auto-enrolment
- Staff discount: 40% on books, food, and drink

How to Apply

To apply, please send your CV and a cover letter to contact@bookcellar.uk by 3rd April 2026. We will be reviewing applications as they arrive and reserve the right to close the window early, so we'd encourage you to apply promptly.

In your cover letter, please include a recommendation for a book you have read and loved recently, not just the title, but why it moved you, stayed with you, or why you'd press it into someone's hands and, if you're feeling brave, what drink you would pair it with.